



# ENERGY WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 17 MAY 2026 - 23 MAY 2026

## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Grid risk this week is a reliability-and-continuity story rather than a single dramatic failure. The pressure came from power outage, power tariff / pricing and load shedding. Philippines carried the most visible grid strain, alongside Pakistan and India. The most serious reached moderate.

Behind the individual events sits the structural picture: thin generation margins, ageing transmission and a heavy dependence on fuel-to-power supply that turns a hot afternoon or a tripped substation into hours of lost load. Outages, load shedding and shortfall are the symptoms; the underlying weakness is a grid with little room to absorb a shock.

For business users the implication is operational, not abstract: unplanned downtime, generator hours and the running cost of keeping critical sites lit. Backup power, fuel cover for extended outages and a clear view of single-source grid dependence are the measures that earn their keep while this picture holds.

## FAST FACTS

|                                                                        |                                                                              |                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>REPORTING PERIOD</div> <div>17 May - 23 May 2026</div>            | <div>TOTAL RECORDS</div> <div>9</div> <div>Energy this period</div>          | <div>HIGHEST SEVERITY</div> <div>Moderate</div> <div>Highest rating this period</div> |
| <div>TOP ISSUE TYPE</div> <div>Power outage</div> <div>4 records</div> | <div>MOST AFFECTED COUNTRY</div> <div>Philippines</div> <div>2 records</div> | <div>LATEST INCIDENT</div> <div>23 May 2026</div>                                     |

## MARKET PRICES

ELECTRICITY (US CITY AVG)  
US city average retail electricity

**0.196** USD/kWh  
+1.0% MoM



As of May 2026 · BLS / FRED (APU000072610)

NATURAL GAS (EUROPE)  
EU import natural gas

**15.9** USD/MMBtu  
+3.3% MoM



As of May 2026 · IMF / FRED (PNGASEUUSDM)

NATURAL GAS (HENRY HUB)  
Henry Hub natural gas spot

**3.330** USD/MMBtu  
+5.4% 7d



As of 29 Jun 2026 · EIA / FRED (DHHNGSP)

THERMAL COAL (AUSTRALIA)  
Australian thermal coal

**141.45** USD/mt  
-0.5% MoM



As of May 2026 · IMF / FRED (PCOALAUUSDM)

## SITUATION

Capacity margins stay thin and fuel-to-power supply remains the underlying weakness, so the grid has little headroom when demand peaks or a feeder trips. This matters because reliability and cost move together here: every hour of lost load is both a continuity problem and a generator-fuel bill, and long restorations turn a brief dip into real operational disruption. Philippines sits at the centre of the current reporting.

## WHAT HAPPENED

Reporting centred on power outage, power tariff / pricing and load shedding. Reporting concentrated on Philippines, with more from Pakistan and India. The most serious reached moderate.

## WHAT MATTERS

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Reliability gaps land first on site uptime and generator load, then on the running cost of business continuity. When outages run long the cost shifts from inconvenience to fuel burn, spoiled stock, missed production and overtime to recover. Exposure to Philippines is the live pressure point for backup power, generator fuel and continuity spend.

Where weak generation margins meet a transmission fault or a fuel-supply squeeze, the impact compounds: load shedding deepens, restoration slows, and sites on a single grid feed lose the buffer they assumed they had. That is the exposure worth planning against now, rather than after the next peak-demand failure.

## IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

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- Check backup generator cover and service status against a multi-hour outage, not just a brief dip.
- Hold fuel stock for extended generator runtime wherever the public grid is the only feed.
- Confirm UPS run-time and failover on critical loads - servers, cold chain, life-safety and security systems.
- Map single-source dependence on the public grid and line up alternate supply or on-site generation before the next peak.
- Build outage cost into continuity budgets - fuel burn, spoilage, lost production and recovery overtime add up fast on long restorations.

## WATCH NEXT

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- Load-shedding schedules - fresh rationing notices are the clearest sign generation margins are tightening.

## POLESTAR VIEW

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Energy Watch is flagging standing grid fragility rather than a single dramatic failure. The risk is structural - thin generation margins and heavy fuel-to-power dependence - so the operational answer is resilience: backup power, fuel cover and a clear view of single-grid dependence. Philippines is the clearest country pressure point, with the rest of the picture filled in by Pakistan and India.

## RELATED INCIDENTS

| DATE        | TYPE                     | TITLE                                                                                                                                                                                                           | SEVERITY |
|-------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| 23 May 2026 | Power outage             | Gurugram power outage: What caused massive blackout on Friday - from oil leakage in transformer to blast<br><br>Power outage, reported 23 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.                              | MODERATE |
| 22 May 2026 | Power outage             | Major Blackout Hits Parts of Sumatra, Indonesia<br><br>Power outage, reported 22 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.                                                                                       | MODERATE |
| 22 May 2026 | Power tariff / pricing   | New power tariff may raise bills for homes using over 400 units from July - Nation Thailand<br><br>Power tariff / pricing, reported 22 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.                                      | LOW      |
| 21 May 2026 | Power outage             | Power outages up in Visayas due to manual load dropping<br><br>Power outage, reported 21 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.                                                                                    | LOW      |
| 21 May 2026 | Power tariff / pricing   | Govt. will not seek electricity tariff hike until September<br><br>Power tariff / pricing, reported 21 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.                                                                      | LOW      |
| 20 May 2026 | Load shedding            | Power generation hits record 17,200MW amid 400MW load-shedding<br><br>Load shedding, reported 20 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.                                                                            | LOW      |
| 20 May 2026 | Fuel-to-power disruption | Power tariff likely to rise by Rs1.72/unit under April FCA<br><br>Fuel-to-power disruption, reported 20 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.                                                                     | LOW      |
| 19 May 2026 | Power tariff / pricing   | Electricity prices may drop by Rs1.93 per unit<br><br>Power tariff / pricing, reported 19 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.                                                                                   | LOW      |
| 18 May 2026 | Power outage             | Philippines: Rotational brownouts hit Luzon, 'Yellow' alert up in Visayas as heatwave, plant outages, line failures push grid to the brink<br><br>Power outage, reported 18 May 2026, assessed at Low severity. | LOW      |

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